

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1158

By Wright

A RESOLUTION to recognize the 150th anniversary of the first telephone call and the founding of AT&T.

WHEREAS, March 10, 2026, marked the 150th anniversary of the first telephone call and the founding of the American Telephone and Telegraph Company (AT&T); and

WHEREAS, on March 10, 1876, Alexander Graham Bell placed the first telephone call to his assistant, Thomas Watson, speaking the historic words, "Mr. Watson, come here. I want to see you," thereby ushering in a new era of communication; and

WHEREAS, over the past 150 years, telecommunications innovation has transformed how individuals live, how businesses operate, and how communities connect across the United States and around the world; and

WHEREAS, AT&T has been a leading force in advancing connectivity and communications throughout the United States for a century and a half; and

WHEREAS, AT&T has evolved from a landline telephone provider into a wireless, broadband, and media company, yet its mission has remained constant: to serve Americans by providing the connectivity necessary to stay informed, productive, and connected; and

WHEREAS, what began as a single phone call in 1876 has grown into an essential part of everyday life, enabling individuals, families, businesses, and communities to remain connected; and

WHEREAS, continued investment in modern communications networks and high-speed broadband infrastructure is essential to expanding access to education, telemedicine, health care, and economic opportunity for the residents of the State of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE

CONCURRING, that we commend AT&T on the occasion of its 150th anniversary and express our deep appreciation for a century and a half of innovation and investment in the phone and the future of the State of Tennessee.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.